

Market Segmentation & Data Sourcing Playbook — FirstKnock.online

Market Segmentation & Data Sourcing Playbook

A Production-Ready Guide to Building a Verified B2B Prospect List for D2D & Field Sales Companies

Q3 2025

This playbook is the definitive operational guide for SDRs, founders, and growth ops teams at FirstKnock.online. Every section is designed to be immediately executable — no technical background required. Follow the workflow in Section 8 to go from zero to 500 verified, segmented prospects ready for cold outreach.

Executive Summary

FirstKnock.online is a CRM and geographic territory mapping application purpose-built for door-to-door (D2D) and field sales teams. The platform solves the most acute operational pain points in field sales: territory overlap, rep tracking, route optimization, and CRM adoption gaps. This playbook provides a complete, repeatable system for identifying, sourcing, enriching, and segmenting the companies most likely to purchase FirstKnock.

Who This Playbook Is For

- SDRs and BDRs responsible for building outbound prospect lists
- Founders and growth ops leads managing the full GTM motion
- Marketing teams building segmented email sequences by vertical
- Anyone at FirstKnock tasked with generating pipeline from scratch

Primary Target Personas

Table 1 — Target Persona Overview by Role and Authority

Persona	Title Examples	Company Stage	Decision Authority
Owner / Founder	Owner, Founder, President	1–10 field reps, bootstrapped or early-stage	Full budget authority — primary buyer
VP of Sales	VP Sales, Head of Sales, Sales Director	10–50 reps, growth stage	Strong influence, often initiates purchase
Director of Field Operations	Field Ops Director, Operations Manager	20+ reps, structured ops	Evaluates tools, recommends to leadership

CRO	Chief Revenue Officer, Revenue Lead	Series A+, scaling fast	Strategic buyer, ROI-focused
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Target Verticals

- Solar Installation (residential and commercial)
- Roofing (storm restoration, new construction, replacement)
- Pest Control (residential recurring service)
- Telecom/ Fiber Broadband (door-to-door subscriber acquisition)
- HVAC (installation, replacement, service agreements)

Expected Output: A verified, segmented prospect list of 500+ companies with owner contact info, permit volume signals, job posting intent scores, and personalization notes — ready for cold email outreach via Instantly.ai or Smartlead.

Section 1: Target Persona Deep-Dive

Persona 1: Owner / Founder (Primary Buyer)

Typical Title	Owner, Founder, President, Principal
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Company Size	1–10 field reps; \$500K–\$5M annual revenue
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Tech Sophistication	Low to moderate — uses spreadsheets or basic CRM
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Decision Timeline	Fast (days to weeks) — no procurement committee
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The Owner/Founder is the highest-priority persona for FirstKnock. They are operationally hands-on, often managing territory assignments manually via Google Maps or paper routes. They feel the pain of territory overlap directly — when two reps knock the same street, they hear about it. They are price-sensitive but will pay immediately when the ROI is clear.

- Pain Points Specific to D2D Operations:
- Territory overlap causing rep conflict and wasted hours
- No visibility into where reps are during the day
- Reps using personal phones and losing lead data when they quit

- No system for tracking which doors have been knocked
- Onboarding new reps takes weeks because there's no documented territory structure
- Buying Triggers:
- Hiring their 3rd or 4th field rep (coordination breaks down)
- A rep quits and takes all their leads
- A competitor is clearly outpacing them in the same zip codes
- Seeing a job posting for 'Territory Manager' at a competitor

Persona 2: VP of Sales

Typical Title	VP Sales, Head of Sales, National Sales Director
Company Size	10–50 field reps; \$3M–\$20M revenue
Tech Sophistication	Moderate — uses Salesforce, HubSpot, or JobNimbus
Decision Timeline	2–6 weeks; may require founder sign-off on budget

The VP of Sales owns the number and is accountable for rep productivity. They are frustrated by the gap between CRM data and what's actually happening in the field. They want dashboards, not spreadsheets. They are actively evaluating tools and respond well to ROI-framed messaging (e.g., 'reduce territory overlap by 40%, increase doors knocked per rep by 25%').

- Key Pain Points:
- Cannot see real-time rep activity without calling them
- Territory assignments are informal and cause conflict
- No data on which neighborhoods convert vs. which are saturated
- Ramp time for new reps is too long without structured territory maps
- Why They Buy FirstKnock:
- Geographic territory mapping eliminates overlap disputes
- Rep tracking provides accountability without micromanagement
- Historical knock data informs smarter territory design

Persona 3: Director of Field Operations

Typical Title	Field Ops Director, Operations Manager, Regional Manager
Company Size	20–100 reps; multi-region operations
Tech Sophistication	Moderate to high — manages tech stack
Decision Timeline	4–8 weeks; evaluates integrations and onboarding

The Director of Field Operations is the internal champion who evaluates tools before recommending them upward. They care about implementation, integrations (does it connect to their existing CRM?), and rep adoption rates. They have been burned by tools that reps refuse to use. They respond to demos, case studies, and free trials.

Persona 4: CRO (Chief Revenue Officer)

Typical Title	CRO, Chief Revenue Officer, SVP Revenue
Company Size	50+ reps; Series A or beyond
Tech Sophistication	High — owns full revenue tech stack
Decision Timeline	6–12 weeks; formal evaluation process

The CRO thinks in terms of revenue per rep, cost of customer acquisition, and market penetration rates. They are evaluating FirstKnock as a strategic investment in field sales infrastructure. Lead with data: territory optimization studies, rep productivity benchmarks, and churn reduction from better lead tracking. This persona is less common in the 1–10 rep segment but becomes relevant as companies scale.

Section 2: Industry Vertical Profiles

Table 2 — Solar Vertical Profile

Attribute	Detail
Typical Headcount	5–50 employees total; 2–15 field sales reps
Seasonality	Peak: March–October; Slower: Nov–Feb (weather-dependent)
Buying Cycle	Spring ramp-up (Feb–March) is prime outreach window
Top States	CA, TX, FL, AZ, NJ, MA, NY, CO
Permit Types	Solar PV installation permits, electrical permits, rooftop permits
Permit Threshold	5+ solar permits/year = likely has dedicated sales team; 20+ = scaling
Key Pain Points	Territory saturation in dense suburban markets; rep overlap in same HOA communities; tracking which homes have been pitched vs. installed
FirstKnock Value	Map solar-eligible zip codes by permit density; assign reps to non-overlapping zones; track pitch-to-install pipeline geographically

2.2 Roofing

Table 3 — Roofing Vertical Profile

Attribute	Detail
Typical Headcount	3–30 employees; 1–10 field sales reps (storm chasers)
Seasonality	Storm season April–October; post-hail surge within 2–4 weeks of event
Buying Cycle	Reactive to weather events; proactive outreach best in Feb–March pre-season
Top States	TX, CO, OK, KS, MO, FL, GA, NC, TN
Permit Types	Roofing permits, re-roofing permits, storm damage repair permits

Permit Threshold	20+ permits/year = active operation with field reps; 50+ = regional player
Key Pain Points	Deploying reps to storm-hit neighborhoods quickly; avoiding duplicate canvassing; tracking which streets have been worked post-storm
FirstKnock Value	Rapid territory deployment after storm events; real-time rep location tracking; neighborhood-level knock tracking

2.3 Pest Control

Table 4 — Pest Control Vertical Profile

Attribute	Detail
Typical Headcount	5–40 employees; 2–12 field sales reps
Seasonality	Peak: March–September; termite swarm season (Feb–May in Southeast)
Buying Cycle	Annual license renewals as proxy for activity; spring ramp-up
Top States	FL, TX, GA, AL, SC, NC, CA, LA
Permit Types	Business license renewals; pesticide applicator licenses (state-level)
Permit Threshold	License renewal activity + Google review recency as primary signals
Key Pain Points	Route efficiency for recurring service; D2D canvassing for new subscriber acquisition; tracking which neighborhoods have been saturated
FirstKnock Value	Route optimization for recurring service calls; canvassing maps for new customer acquisition; rep performance by territory

2.4 Telecom / Fiber Broadband

Table 5 — Telecom/Fiber Vertical Profile

Attribute	Detail
Typical Headcount	10–200 employees; 5–50 D2D reps (often contract/1099)
Seasonality	Year-round; accelerates with RDOF/BEAD grant announcements
Buying Cycle	Tied to ISP expansion rollouts and franchise territory launches
Top States	Rural expansion zones nationwide; TX, FL, OH, PA, NC, MI
Permit Types	Utility permits, conduit/trenching permits, right-of-way permits
Permit Threshold	Right-of-way permit clusters in a zip code = active fiber buildout
Key Pain Points	Managing large 1099 D2D contractor workforces; tracking subscriber acquisition by address; preventing reps from re-knocking opted-out homes
FirstKnock Value	Address-level knock tracking; 1099 rep management; territory assignment for franchise expansion zones

2.5 HVAC

Table 6 — HVAC Vertical Profile

Attribute	Detail
Typical Headcount	5–50 employees; 1–8 field sales reps
Seasonality	Peak: May–August (cooling) and Oct–Dec (heating); shoulder seasons for proactive sales
Buying Cycle	Pre-season outreach (April, September) is highest-converting window
Top States	TX, FL, AZ, GA, NC, SC, TN, AL, CA
Permit Types	HVAC mechanical permits, equipment replacement permits, new construction HVAC permits
Permit Threshold	15+ HVAC permits/year = active operation; 30+ = likely has dedicated sales reps

Key Pain Points	Scheduling in-home consultations efficiently; tracking which neighborhoods have aging HVAC systems (high-conversion zones); rep territory management
FirstKnock Value	Territory mapping by neighborhood age/housing stock; appointment tracking; rep route optimization

Section 3: Free & Low-Cost Public Data Sources

3.1 Municipal Building Permit Databases

Municipal permit databases are the single highest-quality free data source for identifying active contractors. Permits are filed by the contractor doing the work, meaning every permit record is a direct signal of active business operations. The key is filtering by permit type and recency (last 6–12 months).

Table 7 — Municipal Permit Portal Quick Reference

Portal	URL	States/Coverage	Export Format	Time to 100 Leads
permit.city	permit.city	Nationwide aggregator	CSV download	30–60 min
OpenPermits.org	openpermits.org	Multi-state	CSV/API	45–90 min
Riverside CA Portal	riversideca.gov/permits	Riverside, CA	JSON, XML, CSV	20–30 min
Volusia County FL	vcconnect.volusia.org	Volusia County, FL	Web export	45–60 min
Brevard County FL	brevardfl.gov/BuildingPermits	Brevard County, FL	Web search/export	45–60 min
Collier County FL	cvportal.colliercountyfl.gov	Collier County, FL	Web search	60–90 min
City of Clearwater FL	myclearwater.com	Clearwater, FL	Public access, no login	30–45 min
City of Aventura FL	cityofaventura.com	Aventura, FL	Public access	30–45 min

How to Search by Permit Type: When accessing any permit portal, use the following search terms in the 'permit type' or 'work type' field to target your vertical:

- Solar: 'Solar PV', 'Solar Installation', 'Photovoltaic', 'Rooftop Solar', 'Electrical — Solar'
- Roofing: 'Roofing', 'Re-Roof', 'Roof Replacement', 'Storm Damage Repair'
- HVAC: 'Mechanical', 'HVAC', 'Air Conditioning', 'Heating', 'Equipment Replacement'
- Pest Control: Search state licensing boards instead (no permit type for pest control)
- Telecom: 'Right-of-Way', 'Utility', 'Conduit', 'Fiber Installation', 'Telecommunications'

Recency Filter: Always filter for permits filed in the last 6–12 months. In Q3 2025, 83.94% of all tracked permits were classified as active — meaning recent permit data is highly reliable as an activity signal. Contractors pulling 10+ permits annually in a specific region are highly likely to have dedicated field reps or D2D teams.

3.2 State Contractor Licensing Databases

Table 8 — State Contractor Licensing Database Reference

State	Agency	URL	License Types Available	Key Data Fields
California	CA CSLB	contractors.ca.gov	General, Solar, Roofing, HVAC, Electrical, Plumbing	Company name, owner name, license #, bond amount, license status, address, phone
Florida	FL DBPR	myfloridalicense.com	Roofing (CCC/RCC), Solar, HVAC, Telecom, Electrical	Business name, owner, license type, status, address, county
Texas	TX TDLR	tdlr.texas.gov	HVAC, Electrical, Plumbing, Irrigators	Licensee name, business name, city, license type, expiration
West Virginia	WV HVAC Board	wvhvac.wv.gov	HVAC Systems Directory	Contractor name, address, license status
Arizona	AZ ROC	roc.az.gov	General, Solar, Roofing, HVAC	Company name, qualifier name, license #, address, phone, bond
Georgia	GA Secretary of State	sos.ga.gov/licensing	Electrical, Plumbing, HVAC	Business name, license type, status, address

Colorado	CO DORA	dora.colorado.gov	Electrical, Plumbing, HVAC	Licensee name, business, address, license status
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How to Extract Data from State Boards: Most state licensing boards offer a public search interface. For bulk extraction, use the Contractor Leads Scraper tool (via Apify) which is specifically built to extract structured data from state boards like the CA CSLB via API, SDK, or CLI. Pricing starts at \$150 per 1,000 records. For manual extraction, use the search filters to narrow by license type (e.g., 'C-46 Solar' in California) and export or copy results into a spreadsheet.

3.3 BBB Directory

URL	bbb.org/search
Search Method	Filter by category (e.g., 'Solar Energy Contractors') and location (city or zip code)
Data Available	Business name, address, phone, years in business, accreditation status, complaint history
Extraction Method	Manual copy for small lists; Instant Data Scraper Chrome extension for bulk extraction
Time to 100 Leads	60–90 minutes manual; 15–20 minutes with Instant Data Scraper

Pro Tip: BBB complaint history is a hidden gem for D2D targeting. Companies with complaints specifically mentioning 'door-to-door sales' or 'sales representative visited my home' are confirmed D2D operators — exactly the companies FirstKnock should target. Filter for accredited businesses with 3+ years in operation for higher-quality leads.

3.4 Angi (Angie's List) Contractor Profiles

URL	angi.com/companylist
Search Method	Select service category (e.g., 'Solar Panel Installation') and enter zip code or city
Data Available	Business name, owner name (sometimes), phone number, years in business, review count, rating, service area, licensing signals
Extraction Tool	Angi Scraper with Contacts via Apify — automates profile extraction and standardizes output for CRM import
Pricing	\$3.99 per 1,000 results via Apify
Time to 100 Leads	20–30 minutes with Apify actor

Angi profiles are particularly valuable because they include review counts and years in business — two strong proxies for company size and activity level. A contractor with 50+ reviews and 5+ years in business is almost certainly an active operation. Filter for companies with 10+ reviews filed in the last 12 months for maximum recency signal.

3.5 Chamber of Commerce Directories

National Directory	uschamber.com/co/chambers
Local Chambers	Search '[city name] chamber of commerce directory' — most publish free member directories

Data Available	Business name, owner name, phone, website, industry category, address
Best Use Case	Supplemental source for smaller markets where permit data is sparse
Extraction Method	Instant Data Scraper or manual copy; most chamber sites are simple HTML tables

3.6 City/County Business License Records

Many cities and counties publish business license data through open data portals. This data is particularly useful for pest control companies (which don't pull building permits) and for verifying that a contractor is actively licensed in a specific jurisdiction.

- Open Data Portals to Check First:
- [data.gov](#) — Federal open data portal with links to municipal datasets
- [\[city\].gov/opendata](#) — Most major cities have dedicated open data portals (e.g., [data.austintexas.gov](#), [data.sfgov.org](#), [data.cityofchicago.org](#))
- Socrata-powered portals — Many counties use Socrata ([tylertech.com/products/socrata](#)) for open data publishing
- FOIA Request Process (for jurisdictions that don't publish openly):
- Step 1: Identify the correct department (usually City Clerk or Building Department)
- Step 2: Submit a written request citing your state's public records law (e.g., FL Sunshine Law, TX Public Information Act, CA Public Records Act)
- Step 3: Request 'all active business licenses issued to contractors in [category] from [date range] in [jurisdiction]'
- Step 4: Specify preferred format: CSV or Excel
- Typical Timeline: 5–10 business days in FL and TX; up to 30 business days in CA
- Typical Cost: \$0–\$50 for electronic records; copying fees may apply for paper records
- States with Strongest Public Records Laws: FL (Sunshine Law — very fast, very broad), TX (Public Information Act — 10 business day response), CO (CORA — strong), WA (Public Records Act — strong)

Section 4: Identifying ACTIVE Contractors (Not Just Any Contractor)

The difference between a cold list and a hot list is activity signals. A contractor who pulled 30 solar permits in the last 6 months is infinitely more valuable than one who pulled 30 permits 3 years ago. This section defines the exact filters and thresholds to use for each vertical.

Table 9 — Permit Volume Thresholds by Vertical

Vertical	Recency Filter	Low Activity	Medium Activity	High Activity (Priority)	Signal Interpretation
Solar	Last 6–12 months	1–4 permits/yr	5–19 permits/yr	20+ permits/yr	20+ = dedicated sales team almost certain
Roofing	Last 6–12 months	1–9 permits/yr	10–19 permits/yr	20+ permits/yr	50+ = regional player with multiple reps
HVAC	Last 6–12 months	1–7 permits/yr	8–14 permits/yr	15+ permits/yr	30+ = structured sales operation
Pest Control	License renewal recency	Lapsed/inactive	Active, 1 location	Active, multi-location	Use Google review recency as
Telecom	Right-of-way permits	1–2 permits/yr	3–9 permits/yr	10+ permits/yr	Cluster in same zip = active buildout

Cross-Referencing Activity Signals

1. Permit Recency Check: Filter all permit exports to 'date issued' within the last 6–12 months. Discard anything older.
2. Business License Status: Cross-reference contractor name against state licensing database to confirm license is 'Active' (not expired, suspended, or revoked).
3. Google Maps Review Recency: Search the company name on Google Maps. If the most recent review is older than 12 months, flag as low-priority. If reviews mention 'sales rep came to my door' or 'knocked on my door,' mark as CONFIRMED D2D.
4. Job Posting Confirmation: Search the company name on Indeed.com. Any active posting for 'Outside Sales,' 'D2D Sales,' or 'Territory Manager' is a HIGH intent signal — move to top of outreach queue.
5. Social Media Activity: Check Facebook/Instagram for the company. Active posting + homeowner-targeted ads = marketing budget exists = likely buying tools.

Platforms like Shovels (shovels.ai) aggregate over 185 million building permits and allow you to filter by contractor, permit type, date range, and geography simultaneously — dramatically accelerating the activity-filtering process for high-volume prospecting.

5.1 Solar — Top Markets & Targeting Logic

Table 10 — Solar Geographic Priority Markets

Market	State	Priority Metros	Why It's a Target	Outreach Timing
California	CA	San Diego, LA, Bay Area, Sacramento	Highest solar permit density nationally; NEM 3.0 policy driving urgency	Year-round; peak Feb–April
Texas	TX	Austin, Houston, DFW, San Antonio	Deregulated energy market; massive suburban growth; no state income tax incentive	Feb–May pre-summer
Florida	FL	Tampa, Orlando, Miami, Jacksonville	Net metering policy; hurricane resilience narrative; year-round sun	Jan–April
Arizona	AZ	Phoenix, Tucson, Scottsdale	Highest sun hours in US; strong utility incentives	Oct–March (avoid summer heat)
New Jersey	NJ	Newark, Trenton, Cherry Hill	Strong SREC market; high electricity rates drive ROI	March–June
Massachusetts	MA	Boston suburbs, Worcester, Springfield	SMART program incentives; high electricity costs	March–June

5.2 Roofing — Hail Belt & Storm Markets

Table 11 — Roofing Geographic Priority Markets

Region	States	Key Markets	Trigger Event	Outreach Window
Hail Belt	TX, CO, OK, KS, MO, NE, IA	DFW, Denver, OKC, Kansas City	Hail storm event (NOAA storm reports)	Within 2–4 weeks post-storm
Hurricane Coast	FL, LA, TX Gulf	Tampa, New Orleans, Houston	Hurricane season June–November	Pre-season: March–May
High-Growth Suburbs	GA, NC, TN, SC	Atlanta, Charlotte, Nashville, Raleigh	New construction boom; aging housing stock	Year-round; peak April–Sept
Midwest Freeze	MN, WI, IL, MI	Minneapolis, Chicago, Detroit	Ice dam damage; spring thaw	March–May

Storm Chaser Targeting Tip: Monitor NOAA's Storm Prediction Center (spc.noaa.gov) and iPropertyManagement storm reports. Within 48 hours of a significant hail event (1"+ hail), roofing contractors in that zip code cluster will begin hiring D2D reps aggressively. This is the single highest-intent moment to reach a roofing company owner.

5.3 Pest Control — Southeast Concentration

- Tier 1 Markets (Highest Density): FL (entire state), TX (Houston, DFW, San Antonio, Austin), GA (Atlanta metro, Savannah), AL, SC, NC
- Tier 2 Markets: CA (Los Angeles, Inland Empire), LA, MS, TN, VA
- Termite-Heavy Priority Zones: Gulf Coast (FL, AL, MS, LA), Low Country SC/GA, Central FL — these regions have the highest termite pressure and highest D2D canvassing activity
- Seasonality: Target outreach in January–February before termite swarm season (Feb–May). Companies are hiring and scaling D2D teams in this window.

5.4 Telecom / Fiber Broadband — Expansion Zones

- RDOF/BEAD Program Areas: The FCC's Broadband Data Collection map (broadbandmap.fcc.gov) identifies underserved areas receiving federal buildout funding — these are active D2D deployment zones
- Key States for Rural Buildout: TX, OH, PA, NC, MI, MN, WI, KY, WV, MS
- Suburban Overbuilders: Companies like Metronet, Brightspeed, and regional ISPs are aggressively deploying D2D teams in suburban markets — target their subcontractors and franchise operators
- Trigger Signal: ISP expansion press releases and FCC license filings are public — monitor for new franchise territory announcements in your target geography

5.5 HVAC — Sun Belt Priority

Table 12 — HVAC Geographic Priority by Tier

Priority Tier	States	Key Markets	Demand Driver
Tier 1	TX, FL, AZ	Houston, Dallas, Tampa, Orlando, Phoenix	Extreme heat; high AC replacement volume
Tier 2	GA, NC, SC, TN	Atlanta, Charlotte, Raleigh, Nashville	Rapid population growth; new construction
Tier 3	CA, NV, AL, LA	LA, Las Vegas, Birmingham, New Orleans	Heat + humidity combination
New Construction	TX, FL, AZ, GA	All major metros	Builder partnerships; new home HVAC installs

Section 6: Data Extraction Methods

6.1 Manual CSV Export — Step-by-Step

1. permit.city Export Process:
2. Go to permit.city and select your target state and county
3. Use the 'Permit Type' filter to select your vertical (e.g., 'Solar')
4. Set date range to 'Last 12 months' using the issued date filter
5. Click 'Export' or 'Download CSV' (available on most county datasets)
6. Open in Excel or Google Sheets; columns will include: contractor name, license number, address, permit type, issue date, project address
7. State Licensing Database Export (CA CSLB Example):
8. Go to contractors.ca.gov/consumers/lic_search.aspx
9. Select license classification (e.g., C-46 for Solar, C-39 for Roofing)
10. Set status filter to 'Active'
11. Export results page by page (CSLB limits to 200 results per page)
12. For bulk extraction, use the Contractor Leads Scraper on Apify (starts at \$150/1,000 records)
13. Cleaning the CSV for Clay.com Import:
14. Remove duplicate rows (use Excel: Data > Remove Duplicates, match on company name + address)
15. Standardize phone number format to (XXX) XXX-XXXX
16. Add a 'Vertical' column and tag each row with the appropriate industry
17. Add a 'Data Source' column (e.g., 'CA CSLB', 'permit.city')
18. Save as UTF-8 encoded CSV before importing to Clay.com

6.2 Chrome Scraping Extensions

These tools require no coding and can be installed in minutes. They are the fastest path to bulk

Table 13 — Chrome Scraping Tools Comparison

Tool	Best For	Installation	Cost	Output Format
Instant Data Scraper	BBB, Chamber directories, simple HTML tables	Chrome Web Store — free install	Free	CSV, Excel
Phantombuster	LinkedIn profiles, Google Maps, Angi	phantombuster.com — account required	From \$56/month	CSV, JSON
Apify	Pre-built actors for BBB, Angi, Google Maps, Indeed	apify.com — account required	Pay-per-use; free tier available	CSV, JSON, Excel

- Instant Data Scraper — How to Use:
- Install from Chrome Web Store (search 'Instant Data Scraper')
- Navigate to the target page (e.g., BBB search results for 'Solar Contractors in Phoenix, AZ')
- Click the Instant Data Scraper icon in your Chrome toolbar
- The tool auto-detects the table or list structure on the page
- Click 'Start Crawling' — it will automatically paginate through results
- Click 'Download CSV' when complete
- Apify — Running Pre-Built Actors:
- Create a free account at apify.com
- Search the Apify Store for your target: 'Angi Scraper,' 'BBB Scraper,' 'Google Maps Scraper'
- Click 'Try for free' on the actor page
- Enter your search parameters (category, location, date range)
- Click 'Start' — results appear in the 'Dataset' tab within minutes
- Download as CSV or connect directly to Clay.com via Apify's Clay integration

6.3 FOIA Requests — Template Language

Use FOIA requests when a jurisdiction doesn't publish permit or business license data online. This is most common in smaller counties and municipalities.

FOIA Request Template: 'Pursuant to [State Public Records Act], I am requesting all building permit records issued between [start date] and [end date] for permit types including [Solar/Roofing/HVAC/Mechanical]. Please include: contractor name, contractor license number, contractor address, contractor phone number, permit type, issue date, and project address. Please provide records in electronic format (CSV or Excel preferred). If there is a fee for this request, please notify me before processing if the fee exceeds \$25.'

- Submission Methods: Email to city clerk or building department; some jurisdictions have

- online FOIA portals (check [city].gov/foia)
- **Response Timelines:** FL — 5–10 business days (Sunshine Law); TX — 10 business days (Public Information Act); CA — 10 business days (CPRA); Most other states — 5–30 business days
 - **Cost:** Electronic records are typically free or under \$25; paper copies may incur per-page fees
 - **Pro Tip:** FL and TX have the strongest and fastest public records laws in the country — prioritize these states for FOIA requests when online data is incomplete

6.4 Google Maps Scraping with Apify

1. Go to apify.com/store and search 'Google Maps Scraper'
2. Open the actor and click 'Try for free'
3. In the 'Search Queries' field, enter queries like: 'solar installation company Austin TX', 'roofing contractor 78701', 'HVAC company Tampa FL'
4. Set 'Max Results' to 100–500 per query
5. Click 'Start' — the actor will extract: business name, address, phone number, website, Google rating, review count, hours of operation, and Google Maps URL
6. Download results as CSV
7. Cross-reference phone numbers and business names against your permit data to confirm active operations
8. Use review count and recency as an activity filter: 10+ reviews with at least one in the last 6 months = active business

Section 7: Intent Signal Identification

7.1 Job Posting Monitoring

A company actively hiring D2D or field sales reps is the single strongest buying signal for FirstKnock. They are actively scaling their field team — which means territory management, rep tracking, and CRM adoption are immediate pain points.

Table 14 — Job Title Intent Signal Reference

Job Title to Monitor	Signal Strength	Interpretation
Outside Sales Representative	HIGH	Active D2D or field sales program
Door-to-Door Sales Representative	VERY HIGH	Confirmed D2D operation
Field Sales Representative	HIGH	Field-based sales team exists
Territory Sales Manager	HIGH	Structured territory management needed

D2D Sales / In-Home Sales Consultant	VERY HIGH	Confirmed D2D; likely needs territory tool
Canvasser / Brand Ambassador	MEDIUM	Early-stage D2D; may be testing model
Regional Sales Manager	MEDIUM	Scaling; multiple territories being managed

Interpreting Posting Volume: The number of active postings for the same role is a strong indicator of growth stage and urgency:

- 1 posting = Testing the D2D model; early-stage buyer; nurture sequence appropriate
- 2–3 postings = Actively scaling; warm prospect; direct outreach appropriate
- 4–5 postings = Aggressive growth; HOT prospect; prioritize immediately
- 5+ postings across multiple locations = Regional expansion; high-value account; consider personalized video outreach

Setting Up Automated Job Posting Alerts

1. Google Alerts: Go to [google.com/alerts](https://www.google.com/alerts). Create alerts for: "door-to-door sales" "solar" hiring', "outside sales rep" "roofing" job', "field sales" "HVAC" "now hiring". Set frequency to 'As it happens' for real-time signals.
2. Indeed Email Alerts: Search Indeed for your target job title + industry + location. Click 'Get email alerts' to receive daily digests of new postings matching your criteria.
3. LinkedIn Job Alerts: Search LinkedIn Jobs for 'D2D Sales Solar California.' Click 'Set Alert' to receive notifications when new matching jobs are posted.
4. Phantombuster LinkedIn Job Scraper: Automates bulk extraction of job postings matching your criteria. Outputs company name, job title, posting date, and company size. Integrate with Clay.com for enrichment.
5. Clay.com Job Posting Enrichment: Clay has a native 'Job Postings' enrichment column — add it to your prospect table to automatically check if a company has active field sales postings without manual searching.

7.2 Additional Intent Signals

Table 15 — Intent Signal Reference Guide

Signal	Where to Find It	How to Use It	Priority Level
Google review mentions 'knocked on my door'	Google Maps reviews	Search company name; read recent reviews for D2D mentions	VERY HIGH — confirmed D2D
BBB complaints about D2D tactics	bbb.org complaint section	Filter complaints by 'sales practices'; D2D mentions = confirmed operator	HIGH
Facebook/Instagram homeowner-targeted ads	Facebook Ad Library (adlibrary.facebook.com)	Search company name; active ads targeting homeowners = marketing budget	MEDIUM-HIGH
Recent funding announcement	Crunchbase, press releases, LinkedIn	Series A+ = scaling; budget for tools exists	HIGH
Franchise expansion announcement	Franchise disclosure documents, press releases	New franchise territories = immediate need for territory	VERY HIGH
LinkedIn employee count growth	LinkedIn company page	mapping tool 20%+ headcount growth in 12 months = scaling; likely buying tools	MEDIUM-HIGH

Section 8: Step-by-Step Workflow — From Scratch to 500 Verified Leads

This 3-week workflow is designed for a single SDR or founder with no prior list-building experience. Follow each step in order. Expected output: 500 verified, segmented prospect records with owner email, phone, permit volume, and intent score — ready for cold outreach.

Week 1: Data Collection (Days 1–5)

1. Choose your target vertical and geography. Start narrow: e.g., 'Solar installation companies in Texas.' One vertical, one state. You can expand after the first campaign.
2. Pull permit data from permit.city or the relevant state/county portal. Filter by: permit type = Solar, date issued = last 12 months, state = TX. Export CSV. Target: 300–500 raw permit records.
3. From the permit CSV, extract unique contractor names and addresses. Delete duplicate contractor entries (keep the one with the most recent permit date). Target: 150–200 unique contractors.

4. Supplement with TX TDLR licensing database (tdlr.texas.gov). Search for active solar/electrical contractors. Export or manually copy company name, owner name, address, phone. Add to your master CSV.
5. Scrape Angi for the same geography using the Apify Angi Scraper actor (\$3.99/1,000 results). Search 'Solar Panel Installation' + major TX cities (Houston, Austin, DFW, San Antonio). Export CSV.
6. Scrape Google Maps using Apify Google Maps Scraper. Queries: 'solar installation company Houston TX', 'solar contractor Austin TX', 'solar panel installer Dallas TX'. Export CSV.
7. Combine all CSVs into one master spreadsheet. Deduplicate by company name + city (use Excel: Data > Remove Duplicates). Add columns: Vertical, Geography, Data Source. Target: 400–600 unique companies after deduplication.

Week 2: Enrichment via Clay.com (Days 6–10)

1. Create a free Clay.com account at clay.com. You receive 100 free credits/month on the free tier; upgrade to Starter (\$149/month) for 2,000 credits if needed.
2. Import your master CSV into a new Clay table. Map columns: Company Name, Address, City, State, Phone, Data Source.
3. Add an Apollo.io enrichment column: Click '+' > 'Enrich' > 'Apollo — Find Person.' Set lookup criteria: Title contains 'Owner' OR 'Founder' OR 'President,' Company = [Company Name]. This will return owner name, email, LinkedIn URL, and phone.
4. Add a Hunter.io enrichment column as fallback for any rows where Apollo returned no result. Hunter.io finds emails by domain — you'll need the company website URL first (add a 'Find Website' enrichment step before Hunter).
5. Filter the table to show only companies with 1–10 employees (use Apollo's employee count field). This is your core ICP. Flag 11–50 employee companies as 'Tier 2.'
6. Add a job posting signal column: Use Clay's 'Job Postings' enrichment or manually check Indeed for each company. Tag each row: 'No Postings,' '1 Posting,' '2–3 Postings,' '4+ Postings.'
7. Add a permit volume column: Manually enter the permit count from your Week 1 permit data for each company. This becomes your activity score.

Week 3: Verification, Segmentation & Export (Days 11–15)

1. Export your enriched Clay table as CSV. You should have 400–600 rows with owner name, email, phone, employee count, permit volume, and job posting signal.
2. Run email verification using ZeroBounce (zerobounce.net) or NeverBounce (neverbounce.com). Upload your CSV, run bulk verification. Cost: approximately \$8–\$15 for 500 emails.
3. Remove all emails flagged as: Invalid, Catch-All (optional — catch-alls have ~50% deliverability), Role-Based (info@, sales@, contact@), Disposable. Target: retain 60–75% of emails after verification.

- Assign an Intent Score to each record based on the following logic: HIGH = 4+ job postings OR 20+ permits + any job posting; MEDIUM = 1–3 job postings OR 10–19 permits; LOW = no job postings AND under 10 permits.
- Segment your final list into three tabs in your spreadsheet: HIGH Intent (outreach immediately), MEDIUM Intent (sequence 2), LOW Intent (nurture or discard).
- Export each segment as a separate CSV. Import into Instantly.ai (starts at \$37.90/month) or Smartlead for cold email sending. Map fields: First Name, Company Name, Vertical, City, Permit Volume, Intent Score for personalization variables.
- Set up your sending domain (use a subdomain like mail.firstknock.online), warm it up for 2 weeks minimum before sending, and launch your first sequence to the HIGH Intent segment.

Section 9: Cost Breakdown & Budget Planning

Table 16 — Full Tool Cost Breakdown for 500 and 2,000 Leads/Month

Tool / Source	Free Tier	Paid Tier Pricing	Est. Cost: 500 Leads/mo	Est. Cost: 2,000 Leads/mo	Notes / Alternatives
permit.city	Fully free	N/A	\$0	\$0	Best free source; start here
Riverside CA Portal	Fully free	N/A	\$0	\$0	CSV/JSON direct download
Instant Data Scraper	Fully free	N/A	\$0	\$0	Chrome extension; no account needed
Apify (Google Maps/Angi/BB B)	\$5 free credits/month	Pay-per-use; ~\$3.99–\$15/1,000 results	\$5–\$20	\$20–\$60	Pre-built actors; easiest scraping option
Phantombuster	Limited free tier	From \$56/month	\$56	\$56	Best for LinkedIn scraping
Contractor Leads Scraper (Apify)	None	\$150/1,000 records	\$75 (500 records)	\$300	Use for CA CSLB bulk extraction
Clay.com	100 credits/month	Starter: \$149/mo (2,000 credits)	\$0–\$149	\$149–\$299	Core enrichment hub; worth the investment

Apollo.io	Limited free tier	Basic: \$49/mo; Professional: \$99/mo	\$49	\$99	Best for owner email + phone enrichment
Hunter.io	25 searches/month free	Starter: \$34/month	\$0–\$34	\$34	Fallback email finder by domain
ZeroBounce	100 free verifications/m	\$16 per 2,000 verifications	\$0–\$8	\$16	Best email verification tool
NeverBounce	None	\$8 per 1,000 verifications	\$4	\$16	Alternative to ZeroBounce
Instantly.ai	None	Starts at \$37.90/month	\$37.90	\$37.90	Cold email sending platform
Pipeline Labs	None	\$1 per 1,000 leads	\$0.50	\$2	Apollo alternative; very low cost
B2B LinkedIn Lead Gen (Apify)	None	\$2.00/run + \$0.06/lead	\$5–\$35	\$20–\$125	Good for decision-maker targeting

\$0–\$50 Minimum Monthly Cost (Free Tools Only)	~\$350 Recommended Stack (500 Leads/mo)	~\$600 Full Stack Cost (2,000 Leads/mo)	\$0.18 Avg. Cost Per Verified Lead
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Budget Recommendation for Early-Stage FirstKnock SDRs: Start with the free stack (permit.city + Instant Data Scraper + Clay.com free tier + Apollo.io free tier + ZeroBounce free tier) for your first 100 leads. Once you validate your messaging and see replies, invest in Clay.com Starter (\$149/mo) + Apollo.io Basic (\$49/mo) + Instantly.ai (\$37.90/mo) for a full 500-lead/month operation at approximately \$236/month total.

Section 10: Sample Workflow Output

Below is an example of what a completed prospect record looks like after passing through the full 3-week workflow described in Section 8. This is the data structure you should aim to have for every record before sending a cold email.

Table 17 — Sample Completed Prospect Record

Field	Value
Company Name	Lone Star Solar Solutions LLC
Owner Name	Marcus T. Rivera
Owner Email	marcus@lonestarsolar.com (ZeroBounce: Valid)
Phone	(512) 847-3291
Address	Austin, TX 78701
Industry	Solar Installation
Employee Count	7 (per Apollo.io)
Permit Volume (Last 12 mo)	34 solar permits (TX permit portal)
Active Job Postings	2 — 'Outside Sales Representative' (Indeed, posted 11 days ago)
Intent Score	HIGH
Data Sources	TX permit portal + Apify Google Maps + Apollo.io enrichment + ZeroBounce verified
Personalization Notes	34 permits in 12 months = scaling fast; 2 active outside sales postings = actively building field team; territory management and rep overlap are almost certainly live pain points. Reference Austin solar market growth in opener. Ask about how they currently assign territories to new reps.

Using this record, an SDR at FirstKnock could write the following personalized cold email opener:

Subject: Territory overlap killing your Austin reps' momentum? Hey Marcus — noticed Lone Star Solar pulled 34 permits in the last 12 months and you're actively hiring outside sales reps right now. That's impressive growth. Quick question: how are you currently assigning territories when a new rep starts? Most solar companies at your stage are still doing it manually in Google Maps — which works until two reps knock the same street on the same day. FirstKnock solves exactly that. Worth a 15-minute look?

Appendix: Resource Directory

Permit & Licensing Databases

Table 18 — Permit & Licensing Resource Directory

Resource	URL	Type	Cost
permit.city	permit.city	National permit aggregator	Free
OpenPermits.org	openpermits.org	Multi-state permit data	Free
Shovels.ai	shovels.ai	185M+ permit database	Paid
CA CSLB	contractors.ca.gov	CA contractor licensing	Free
FL DBPR	myfloridalicense.com	FL contractor licensing	Free
TX TDLR	tdlr.texas.gov	TX contractor licensing	Free
AZ ROC	roc.az.gov	AZ contractor licensing	Free
WV HVAC Board	wvhvac.wv.gov	WV HVAC directory	Free
Riverside CA Permits	riversideca.gov/permits	Riverside, CA permits	Free
Volusia County FL	vcconnect.volusia.org	Volusia County permits	Free
Brevard County FL	brevardfl.gov/BuildingPermits	Brevard County permits	Free
FCC Broadband Map	broadbandmap.fcc.gov	Telecom expansion zones	Free
data.gov	data.gov	Federal open data portal	Free

Scraping & Enrichment Tools

Table 19 — Scraping & Enrichment Tool Directory

Tool	URL	Primary Use	Starting Price
Apify	apify.com	Pre-built scrapers (Angi, BBB, Google Maps, Indeed)	Free tier; pay-per-use
Phantombuster	phantombuster.com	LinkedIn, Google Maps, Angi scraping	From \$56/month
Instant Data Scraper	Chrome Web Store	Browser-based HTML scraping	Free
Clay.com	clay.com	AI enrichment & waterfall prospecting	100 free credits/month
Apollo.io	apollo.io	Contact database & intent signals	From \$49/month

Hunter.io	hunter.io	Email finder by domain	25 free/month; from \$34/month
Pipeline Labs	pipelinelabs.io	Apollo alternative; verified contacts	\$1/1,000 leads
Contractor Leads Scraper	apify.com/store	State board scraping (CA CSLB)	From \$150/1,000 records
ScraperForge LinkedIn	apify.com/scraperforge	LinkedIn employee data extraction	\$19.99/month + usage

Outreach & Verification Tools

Table 20 — Outreach & Verification Tool Directory

Tool	URL	Primary Use	Starting Price
Instantly.ai	instantly.ai	Cold email sending & sequences	From \$37.90/month
Smartlead	smartlead.ai	Cold email sending (alternative)	From \$39/month
ZeroBounce	zerobounce.net	Email verification	100 free/month; \$16/2,000
NeverBounce	neverbounce.com	Email verification (alternative)	\$8/1,000
B2B LinkedIn Lead Gen	apify.com/store	AI-scored decision-maker leads	\$2.00/run + \$0.06/lead
Instantly B2B Lead Finder	instantly.ai/b2b-lead-finder	Integrated lead finder + outreach	From \$37.90/month

Intent Signal Monitoring

Table 21 — Intent Signal Monitoring Resource Directory

Tool / Platform	URL	Use Case	Cost
Google Alerts	google.com/alerts	Monitor D2D hiring announcements	Free
Indeed Job Search	indeed.com	Monitor field sales job postings	Free

LinkedIn Jobs	linkedin.com/jobs	Monitor D2D/outside sales postings	Free
Apify Job Scraper	apify.com/store	Bulk job posting extraction	Pay-per-use
Indeed Scraper (Apify)	apify.com/store	Mass hiring intelligence tracking	Pay-per-use
Facebook Ad Library	adlibrary.facebook.com	Monitor homeowner-targeted ads	Free
NOAA Storm Prediction Center	spc.noaa.gov	Roofing storm event triggers	Free
Crunchbase	crunchbase.com	Funding announcement monitoring	Free tier available

FirstKnock.online | firstknockhelp@gmail.com | This playbook is updated quarterly. For questions about implementation, data sourcing partnerships, or custom prospecting workflows, contact the FirstKnock team directly.